

Medication Name Patterns

Suffixes are study clues, not proof of a drug class or a substitute for checking the label.

Cardiovascular clues -pril often signals an ACE inhibitor. -sartan often signals an ARB. -olol often signals a beta blocker. -dipine often signals a dihydropyridine calcium-channel blocker.	Other common clues -statin: lipid-lowering statin. -prazole: proton-pump inhibitor. -cillin: penicillin-family antibiotic. -gliptin: DPP-4 diabetes medication.
Use the clue safely - Confirm generic name, indication, route, dose, and allergies. - Look-alike names can cross class boundaries. - Use an approved drug reference for monitoring and teaching.	

Reviewed 2026-07-13 - Source: U.S. Food and Drug Administration - <https://www.fda.gov/drugs/drug-safety-and-availability/medication-errors-related-cder-regulated-drug-products>
Study aid only. Verify current references, instructor guidance, scope, orders, and facility policy.